



SERENDIB COLLEGE HISTORY

Ancient settlement
2026/G10&11/History/T-1

1. The history of human existence in Sri Lanka is divided into how many stages? What are they?

Divided into 3 stages as follows;
① Pre historic (stone age)
② Proto historic
③

2. What term refers to the period before literary sources in Sri Lanka?

Pre historic era

3. What are the two cultural stages that belong to the pre-historic era of Sri Lanka?

Stone age & proto historic era

4. Which term is used to describe the era involving permanent settlements, agriculture, and metal use?

Stone age

5. What was the main dependency method of the early Homo Sapiens in Sri Lanka?

Gathering food by roaming and hunting

6. At what depth were Stone Age tools and animal bones found in the Rathnapura gem mines?

About 90 feet deep from ground level.

7. What is the name of the gravel layer in the semi-arid zone that contains Stone Age tools?

Irannadu formation

8. During which geographical era was the soil eroded from mountains to form the Rathnapura gravel layers?

Short warm periods of pleistocene era

9. How many main environmental zones were inhabited by Stone Age communities in Sri Lanka? What are they?

① Semi Arid zone

② Lowland dry zone

③ Lowland intermediate dry zone

④ Wet zone

⑤ Mountainous dry intermediate zone

⑥ Arid zone

10. What is the primary factor used to decide the different environmental zones in Sri Lanka?

Differences of annual rainfall levels

11. What was a major food source for Stone Age people in the lowland wet zone?

Oysters living on land

12. Which animals were commonly hunted by Stone Age communities in the lowland dry zone?

Deer and iguana

13. Where is the 125,000-year-old gravel layer located in the Hambanthota district?

45 feet from surface level in pathirayawela

14. Which Kaluthara cave was a habitation for pre-historic man?

Cave located in Pahiyangala, Bulathsinhala

15. How many years ago was the Kuruwita Batadombalena cave inhabited?

28000 years

16. What is the age of the pre-historic site at Kithulgala Belilena?

15000 years

17. What type of stone, known as 'Bim Weed-uru', was used for geometric stone tools?

Pure alabaster stone

18. Where did pre-historic humans live during the heavy rainy seasons?

Natural caves

19. What are examples of pre-historic outdoor camps in coastal areas?

Minihagalkanda, Burdala, Pathirayawela

20. Give 2 lowland dry zone cave habitations?

~~Pothana~~ Pothana and Aligala

21. Which hillside locations served as outdoor hunting places for pre-historic man?

Bandarawela, Horton plains

22. What was the typical size of a pre-historic human group?

15 - 25 members

23. How much living area was estimated as sufficient for a family of five in the Stone Age?

Area of 50 square meters

24. How many human skeletons were discovered at the site of Bellanbendipelassa?

30 human skeletons

25. How far did pre-historic people walk on average per day searching for food?

About 7 kilometers

26. How many skeletons were discovered in the cave of Belilena in Kithulgala?

12 skeletons

27. Which food provided starch for the people of the Stone Age?

Wild breadfruit and wild plantains mainly

28. Which site provided evidence of baked wild breadfruit seeds from 12,500 years ago?

Cave Belilena in Kithulgala

29. What is the technical term for Stone Age tools under 4.5 cm in length with specific shapes?

Geometric micro stone tools

30. Which stones were primarily used to make micro stone tools?

More Quartz and a little Kahanda stones

31. What was the average height of a grown male and female Stone Age human in Sri Lanka?

174 cm and less than 166 cm, respectively

32. What was the average brain size of a grown male and female during the Stone Age in Sri Lanka?

1600 cm³ and 920 cm³ respectively

33. What was the estimated maximum lifespan of a pre-historic man in Sri Lanka?

About 35-40 years

34. Which cave near Badulla yielded a man's skull painted with red ochre?

Cave of Ravana ella

35. What ritual was performed on pre-historic skeletons after they were exhumed?

Rough edges were rubbed, leveled and a side painted with red ochre

36. Remains of megalithic tradition burials signify which historical era?

Proto historic era.

37. What replaced stone tool technology during the proto-historic era?

Metal technology and making clay pots

38. Which climatic era created an environment suitable for agriculture?

End of the Ice-Age.

39. What are 'cist burials'?

Burials made out of stone splinters in square shape.

40. What is the term for burials where remains were deposited in clay pots?

Urn burials

41. What unique burial method was discovered at Haldummulla and Beragala?

Depositing the clay pots of remains in a tub made of raw clay

42. The characteristic of building and living in permanent settlements is known as

sedentism

43. In which district was a 3000-year-old rectangular house discovered in 2009?

Rathnapuwa district

44. What was found inside the house at Udaranchamadama that suggests the use of a potter's wheel?

Lots of potsherds.

45. Which iron tool found in the Udaranchamadama house indicates women's interest in beauty?

~~Iron da~~ Iron stick to apply Kohl on eyes.

46. What does the presence of animal bones in the proto-historic house at Udaranchamadama suggest?

Although they got used to an agricultural lifestyle,
they did not completely abandon hunting.

47. What is the main physical indicator of settlement expansion during the early historical period?

48. What type of soil in the dry zone was preferred by early historical settlers for its fertility?

The red-brown soil.

49. Why did early settlements expand outside river valleys rather than inside them?

Since there was no suitable technology to control annual floods

50. What Brahmi term inscribed in Ganekanda and Gallena temples means 'anicut'?

'Avarana'

51. What literary term refers to villages centered around a tank?

Alagam Vapigama.

52. Define 'Kasikaragama'

Villages where farmers lived.

53. Define 'Manikaragama'

Villages where people worked in gem mines lived.

54. Define 'Gopalagama'

Villages where cowherds lived.

55. Define 'Kumbhakaragama'

Villages where potters lived.

56. Define 'Pattanagama'

Villages situated close to harbours.

57. Define 'Niyamgam'

Trading villages.

58. Define 'Olagam'

Villages around tanks deserted by people.

59. What term was used to introduce vast urban settlements like Anuradhapura?

'Pura'

60. The title 'Pura Kamatha' mentioned in a 250 B.C. inscription refers to which role?

The main architect in the city.

61. Which settlement type mentioned in inscriptions was intermediate between a city and a village?

Nagara

62. In ancient Sri Lankan administration, who was the 'Gahapathi'?

Chief householder to represent a family.

63. What was the administrative role of the 'Gamika'?

Person who acted behalf of a group of few Gahapathis

64. What was the function of the 'Dasa Gam Eththan'?

Engaging in solving administrative issues in an area joined with ten villages.

65. Archaeologists found pits for house pillars in Anuradhapura with foundations of which two shapes?

Round and square shape.

66. What was the primary means of subsistence for people living outside overflowing river valleys?

Chena cultivation.

67. Name two drought-sustainable crops grown in early historical chena cultivation.

Kurakkan, Sesame.

68. What is the 'Iranamadu Deposit'?

The soil layer deposited on lowlands due immense soil erosion in higher places.

69. How long is a micro stone tool made of alabaster or Kahanda stones?

1 cm - 7 cm.

70. What is an 'overflowing valley' in geography?

The area of the side of a river that goes underwater due to flood in heavy rainy seasons.

71. What is another term for the pre-historic era?

Stone age.

72. Which ancient chronicle mentions a well-organized society existed when Prince Vijaya arrived?

Mahawamsa

73. Define 'Parikkitta Gam'

Village protected by fence.

74. In which district is the Kolambageara Ranchamadama pre-historic cemetery located?

④

75. The 1129 B.C. painted clay pot from Udaranchamadama was decorated with what color lines?

White and red.

76. How many families normally lived in a small-scale ancient village?

④